



BRC's Safety Guidelines Book

Sled Guidelines

Scope:

All BCMG events & hires

Content

The Bogong Rover Chalet have strict guidelines in relation to sleds being brought into the Chalet for a number of safety reasons. This applies to all Chalet Winter Parties and all hires. **The only exception to this, is with prior approval from the Warden.**

Whilst the BCMG reserves the right to not have to explain any policy or guidelines, due to the frequent queries relating to this, the BCMG have decided to detail the reasoning for this below.

1. There are a number of slopes on the ski in / out that make towing a sled very dangerous. In particular Bassalt hill. Using alternative routes would result in either:
 - a. The whole party being diverted to an alternative route which is more challenging and has other inherent risks
 - b. Splitting the party up
2. Sleds being operated by unskilled operators
3. Homemade sleds being unsuitable for the route (eg. A loaded up toboggan)
4. Excessive belongings being brought in with the use of a sled – in particular there are concerns as to a sled being used to bring in excessive alcohol which adds additional alcohol related risks onto a Winter Party
5. Sled users are very likely to slow down the party
6. There is no guarantee of sufficient snow to tow the sled – if so it would be dangerous and challenging to tow the sled without snow

Arguments have previously been made about sleds providing an alternative to packs as an accessibility requirement. As it is a non-negotiable requirement that all participants be able to carry a pack overnight, this is not a justification for requiring a sled. This is due to the BCMG believing that should a participant be unable to carry a pack overnight, they are unsafe to both themselves and others on their Winter Party.



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Sled Training

The BCMG acknowledge that to complete OAS 9 Cross Country Skiing and Guide Qualifications require "I have towed equipment to support an overnight ski touring trip". The BCMG recognise that achieving these qualifications are niche and require skiing on other events beyond BCMG facilitated Winter Parties – therefore not all skills need to be able to be acquired at the Bogong Rover Chalet.

Approved by Risk Sub-Group 26th November 2024

Ratified: 11th December 2024

To be reviewed: No later than October 2027

Update from 1.0 to 1.1 was changing of 1 word. This change was made in February 2025 and deemed to not require ratification. There were no other changes.

